NO. 23 · BUILT ABOUT AD 30, OR A LITTLE LATER

The Pilgrims' Road to the Temple



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The stone street that pilgrims climbed from Siloam to the Temple.

> I was glad when they said unto me, Let us go into the house of the LORD. Our feet shall stand within thy gates, O Jerusalem.
>
> PSALMS 122:1–2 · KJV

FOUND
Excavated in stages from 1999; the main dig ran 2013-2019, under the City of David, Jerusalem

SEE IT TODAY
The City of David, Jerusalem; you can walk part of it underground

What it is

A stepped street about 2,000 feet long and 26 feet wide, paved with an estimated 10,000 tons of limestone. More than 100 coins sealed beneath the paving date its building; the latest are from about AD 31.

What it shows

Pilgrims coming to the feasts walked up from the Pool of Siloam toward the Temple, singing the Psalms of Ascents. This is that road, probably laid while Pontius Pilate governed Judea, so Jesus may have walked it.

What scholars still ask

Some archaeologists, including Jodi Magness, doubt the dating, because coins could have been mixed into the fill; others point to later coins. The tunnelling method used to dig it has also been criticised.

TALK ABOUT IT

'I was glad when they said unto me...' Where is the road you walk to worship?

As seen in Film 2: Jerusalem in the Time of Jesus, As It Really Was · The Bible As It Was

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